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THE FLAGSHIP CHALLENGE

10

The 30-Day Digital Business Challenge

Build Your First Small Online Income System in 30 Days

One market, one problem, one offer, and thirty days of defined work.

30 day cards | Multiple income paths | Daily checklists

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UNDEFINED	UNDEFINED	UNDEFINED

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The 30-Day Digital Business Challenge

Build Your First Small Online Income System in 30 Days

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Read This Before Day One

The $500 Digital Business Challenge — Build Your First Small Online Income System in 30 Days. First Edition · September 2026.

Publisher: NexKit your country Editorial Team. This course was researched, written and edited by the NexKit your country Editorial Team. It carries no individual author name and no personal credentials, because the value of the book is the method, not a personality.

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What this course is

A thirty-day implementation programme. Every day has an objective, an explanation, a task, an example, a checklist and an expected output. It takes you from choosing a market to delivering paid work, and it is designed to be run once, properly, rather than read twice.

What this course is not

It is not a promise that you will earn $500 in thirty days. **$500 is a target used to make the arithmetic concrete**, and it is one of several possible outcomes. Many people who complete this programme will earn less in the first month, some will earn nothing, and some will sign their first client in week five rather than week three. It is not financial, legal or tax advice, and it does not guarantee a client, a sale, a sponsorship or a payout.

DISCLAIMER — READ THIS ONCE, PROPERLY

This course is **educational material only**. Nothing in it is a guarantee of income, and nothing in it is financial, legal or investment advice.

The $500 target is arithmetic, not a forecast. Four worked paths are shown: five clients at $12, ten at $6, twenty at $3, and two at $120. Each is a **target calculation**. Which one is realistic for you depends on your market, your offer, your price and how many conversations you actually start.

All prices, rates and ladders shown in this book are **illustrative examples** for teaching. You are responsible for complying with local law, your tax obligations, the terms of service of any platform you use, and the requirements of any bank, wallet or payment provider you deal with. Rules, fees, limits and country availability change, sometimes quickly.

Where the underlying research could not verify a fact, this book says so and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

DATES, CURRENCY AND EXAMPLES

All money in this course is US US dollars (USD), written as $25. Where a United States dollar figure appears it states its rate and its date on the same line.

Every business named anywhere in these pages is invented. Each is labelled **Example scenario — fictional**. No real, recognisable local company is presented as a client, a case study or a testimonial.

Every figure cited is current as of **September 2026** unless a different date is printed beside it. Source URLs for those figures appear in the **Sources & Further Reading** section at the back of the book.

BEFORE YOU RELY ON ANY OF THIS

Payment limits, wallet rules, tax thresholds and platform availability are the parts of this book most likely to go stale. Treat every number as a starting point for your own check, not as a substitute for it. Where this book names a rule, confirm the current version with the institution that made it.

Last updated: September 2026. Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

What is inside this course

01 · Choose Your Market 10
02 · Choose Your Problem and Your Service 16
03 · Build the Offer and the Proof 22
04 · Build the Prospect List 29
05 · Outreach 34
06 · Proposals, Negotiation and Closing 41
07 · Delivery 46
08 · Payment, Testimonials and the Finish 51

HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.

FRONT MATTER

Before You Start

This is not a book about ideas. It is a thirty-day work order. One market, one problem, one offer, thirty days of defined tasks, and a score sheet you fill in honestly.

What this challenge can help you do

— Choose a market small enough to actually reach — a city or a neighbourhood, a type of business, and a person you can speak to.

— Find a problem in that market that somebody will pay to remove.

— Turn one skill into one offer with a price in dollars and a delivery time you can keep.

— Build proof before you have a client, honestly labelled as sample work.

— Build a named list of forty prospects and start eight conversations a day.

— Send a proposal, handle the price question, close, deliver and collect money through a route that exists for a resident of a country with limited payment access.

— Finish thirty days with a written record of what worked, so the second month is not a restart.

What this challenge cannot do

READ THIS PART TWICE

This challenge cannot promise that you will earn $500. **$500 is a target used to make the arithmetic concrete, and it is not a prediction about you.** Some people who finish all thirty days earn more than that. Many earn less. Some earn nothing in month one and their first payment in month two. A few discover in week three that their market does not buy what they are selling, change the offer, and earn in week six instead of week four.

None of those outcomes means the method failed. What fails is switching markets every four days, collecting twelve ideas, and never sending the eleventh message.

What you need

WHAT YOU NEED	HONEST NOTE	COST
An Android smartphone	Every task in the thirty days can be done on a phone. This is not a consolation — it is the design.	You have it
A data bundle	Indicative third-party pricing is about $0.60 for 2 GB a month. Check your own operator's current bundles.	Your existing bundle
A Google account	Gmail, Drive, Docs, Sheets, Forms and Maps on one login. This is your office.	$0
Telegram	Where a large share of local business conversation happens, and the cheapest way to send files on a weak connection.	$0

WHAT YOU NEED	HONEST NOTE	COST
A wallet or bank account	a mobile wallet, a mobile-money wallet, a bank wallet, a bank wallet, a mobile wallet, a mobile wallet or an ordinary savings account.	$0

WHAT YOU NEED	HONEST NOTE	COST
Optional: laptop access	Occasional. Nothing in the plan is blocked without one.	Varies

Bundle prices are indicative third-party figures and change often. Verify before you plan around a number.

Time: 90 minutes a day for 30 days

That is about forty-five hours across the month, sized for somebody who studies or works. The daily card tells you what to do and what the finished output looks like. The plan includes two buffer days and an explicit rule for what to do when you fall behind, because you will.

If you have less time, do not shorten the calendar. **Do fewer conversations per day.** A thirty-day challenge run at half speed over sixty days still finishes. A thirty-day challenge compressed into nine days produces an unfinished book and no messages sent.

THE MOST IMPORTANT RULE

Do not change your market before Day 21.

Every instinct you have in week two will tell you that you picked the wrong market. That instinct is usually wrong. What is actually happening is that week two is when outreach starts and nobody has replied yet, and your brain would rather change the plan than sit inside the silence.

Write your market on a piece of paper and stick it where you work. On Day 21 you are allowed to change it, once, using the method in section 09. Before Day 21 the answer to "should I change my market?" is no.

The second rule

Keep score in numbers, not feelings. Every day you record five figures: conversations started, replies received, proposals sent, pieces of work delivered, and dollars collected. After thirty days you will have thirty rows of data about your own behaviour. Almost nobody who tries to earn online has that. It is the single most useful thing this challenge gives you, and it costs nothing.

FRONT MATTER

Who This Is For, and Who It Is Not For

This is for you if

— You have a phone, a data bundle and no capital.

— You have read one or more NexKit courses, or you have not read any and simply want one structured programme.

— You are willing to send messages to strangers and be ignored.

— You can give 90 minutes a day for thirty days.

— You want to be told exactly what to do next, not given a menu.

— You are inside your country, or local and working from anywhere with a local bank or wallet account.

This is not for you if

— You want a guaranteed income figure. There isn't one, and any book that gives you one is selling you something else.

— You want to run four ideas at once. This challenge explicitly forbids it.

— You are looking for passive income. Every dollars in this plan is earned by doing work for a person.

— You want to skip the outreach. There is no version of this where clients arrive without messages being sent.

— You cannot commit to thirty days and would rather have a shorter plan. Course 01 is the smaller version.

WHAT FINISHING ACTUALLY MEANS

The deliverable of this challenge is **thirty completed daily cards and a score sheet with thirty rows**. A first payment is the goal. The record is the guarantee. If you finish with a score sheet, you can run month two at double the volume with evidence about what works for you — which is worth more than a single lucky sale.

How to Keep Score

One Google Sheet. Five columns. Thirty rows. Fill it in before you sleep, even on the days when the honest answer is zero.

COLUMN	WHAT YOU RECORD	WHY IT MATTERS
Day	1 to 30	Ties every number to a date so you can see trend, not mood.
Conversations started	Messages sent, calls made, doors walked into	This is the only number you fully control. Everything else is downstream of it.
Replies received	Any response at all, including "no"	Tells you whether your list or your message is the problem.
Proposals sent	Messages that contained a price	Most beginners never reach this column. Reaching it is the real milestone.
Dollars collected	Money actually in your wallet or bank, not promised	The only revenue figure that exists. Promises are not revenue.

Add a sixth column for notes if you want. Keep it short — one line about what you learned that day.

WHAT THE NUMBERS WILL PROBABLY LOOK LIKE

In a typical first run, week one produces almost no conversations and no replies, because you are still building the offer and the list. Week two produces most of the conversations and very few replies. Week three produces the first real replies and the first proposal. Week four produces delivery, payment, or the discovery that your offer needs one change.

This is a description of the usual shape, not a promise. Your run may be faster or slower.

My market (write it here) .....

Date I start Day 1 .....

The person who will check my sheet weekly .....

The third line matters more than it looks. Tell one person you are doing this and show them the sheet once a week. Accountability that costs nothing still works.

If You Have Already Started

You do not have to begin at Day 1. Find where you actually are and join there.

IF YOU ALREADY…	JOIN AT	BUT FIRST
Have a skill but no offer	**Day 4**	Write down your market and problem in one line each. Do not skip that.
Have an offer but no clients	**Day 13**	Check that your offer names a price. An offer without a price is a hobby description.
Have a client and want a second	**Day 16**	Ask the first client for two referrals before you start outreach.
Work in social media or design already	**Day 8**	Rebuild your proof so it matches the market you are now targeting, not the one you drifted into.

RULES IF YOU ARE JOINING MID-WAY

Keep the same scoring sheet and the same no-switching rule. The calendar is a sequence, not a superstition — skipping to Day 16 with no offer and no list simply means you will send proposals that say nothing to people you have not identified.

The Four Target Paths to $500

Four ways the arithmetic can work. All four are targets, none is a forecast, and you do not get to pick the one that happens.

PATH A — FEW CLIENTS, HIGHER PRICE

`5 clients × $12 = $500`

Suits: design, short video, website setup, business documentation. Requires: an offer that looks like a project, not an errand. Slower to close, lighter to deliver.

PATH B — THE MIDDLE ROAD

`10 clients × $6 = $500`

Suits: social-media starter packages, menu and flyer sets, profile setup. Requires: a repeatable package and fast turnaround. This is the most common shape for a first month.

PATH C — VOLUME

`20 sales × $3 = $500`

Suits: small digital products, single-piece design, profile clean-ups, short documents. Requires: twenty separate buyers, which is harder than it sounds and demands a channel where strangers already are.

PATH D — TWO BIG PIECES OF WORK

`2 clients × $120 = $500`

Suits: a monthly retainer starting early, a full catalogue digitisation, a complete website, a training day. Requires: proof, confidence and a buyer who already trusts you. Rare in month one, common in month three.

PATH	ARITHMETIC	CONVERSATIONS IMPLIED	DELIVERY LOAD	BEST FIT
A	5 × $12	Roughly 60–100 to close 5, if you convert about one in fifteen	Heavy per client	Skilled beginners with visible proof
B	10 × $6	Roughly 80–150 to close 10	Moderate	Most first-month attempts
C	20 × $3	Roughly 150–300, or a channel that reaches strangers	Light per sale	Anyone with an audience or a product
D	2 × $120	Roughly 30–60, but to better-qualified buyers	Very heavy	People with a portfolio and a reputation

Conversion rates vary enormously by market, price, offer and how good your first message is. The ranges above are planning assumptions so you can size your daily volume, not measured local conversion data. There is no published local benchmark for this, and any book that prints one is inventing it.

READ THIS BEFORE YOU CHOOSE A PATH

You do not choose your path. **Your market chooses it.** A café owner in the commercial district will pay $9 for a month of social posts. The same owner will not pay $120 in the first conversation. A hotel with a badly digitised catalogue may well pay $120 once, and nothing monthly after that.

Run the challenge with Path B as your working assumption. Adjust upward only after a client says yes to a bigger number, and downward only after five refusals that all mentioned price.

01

DAYS 1 TO 3

Choose Your Market

Three days to turn "everyone where you live" into a named person you can reach by Thursday. This is the decision that determines whether the next twenty-seven days work.

01 Why a market beats an idea

02 The market shortlist method

03 Verifying that buyers exist

04 Scoring three candidates

05 Day 1, Day 2 and Day 3 cards

SECTION 01

01. Choose Your Market

A market is not an audience and it is not an idea. It is a specific group of people, in a place you can reach, who share a problem and have money to spend on it.

1.1 Why a market beats an idea

Most people start with a service — "I will do graphic design" — and then look for somebody to sell it to. That is backwards, and it produces the classic local first-month experience: forty messages sent, no replies, and the conclusion that "there is no market here".

The market comes first. Market first means you know who you are talking to before you decide what to say, what to charge, and what to show them. It means your first message can mention their street, their menu, their last post, or their competitor three doors down.

EXPLAIN A market has four parts: **a place** (a city, a district, a street), **a type of buyer** (cafés, gyms, tour operators), **a shared problem** (they look inactive online, their menu has no prices, their product photos are unusable), and **a way to reach them** (they answer their phone, they are on Google Maps, they have a walk-in shop).

SHOW *Example scenario — fictional.* "Independent cafés in the commercial district and the central district area of your city that have an Instagram page but have not posted in two months. I can find them on Google Maps in an afternoon, their phone number is public, and the owner is usually behind the counter." That is a market. "Cafés where you live" is not.

DO Write three candidate markets in the shortlist table below. Each must name a place, a buyer type, a problem and a way in.

CHECK Read your market line out loud. If it could describe a business anywhere in the world, it is too broad. If it names a place you could travel to tomorrow, it is right.

1.2 The market shortlist method

Fill this table with three candidates. Do not agonise — three is enough, and you will score them in the next step.

MARKET	PLACE	BUYER TYPE	THE PROBLEM	HOW I REACH THEM
A	e.g. the commercial district, the central district, the eastern district	e.g. independent cafés	e.g. page inactive for months	e.g. Google Maps phone number, walk in
B				
C				

YOU ARE NOT LIMITED TO YOUR CITY

The same method works in **a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a smaller town, a smaller town, a smaller town, a smaller town, a smaller town** and smaller towns. In regional cities there are usually fewer competitors offering digital services, the businesses are easier to reach in person, and a stakeholder who knows you socially is more likely to take the meeting.

What changes is the price ceiling and the tools available. What stays the same is the method: pick the place, pick the buyer, find the problem, find the way in.

1.3 Verify that buyers exist before you commit

Do not guess. Spend forty minutes confirming that your market is real and reachable. Use the sources that work where you live today.

SOURCE	WHAT YOU USE IT FOR	WHERE IT WORKS
Google Maps	Find every business of a type in a named area, with phone number, opening hours and reviews. The single most useful prospecting tool available where you live.	Nationwide, densest in your city
a local classifieds site	See who is actively selling, at what price, and how they present themselves. A live feed of local commerce.	Nationwide, strong in Addis
an online business directory	Browse by category with counts, and filter by city. Around thirty categories including restaurants and cafés, professional services, factories and construction.	14 cities
an online business directory	Larger companies and importers. Useful when your offer suits businesses with real budgets.	Nationwide
Telegram and Facebook groups	Where owners actually ask for help. Search the group history for phrases like "who can design", "need a page manager", "who prints".	Nationwide
Walking the street	The most under-used method. Count the businesses in your market on foot and note which ones look busy.	Anywhere

COPY-READY: THE 40-MINUTE VERIFICATION SEARCH

1. Open Google Maps. Search `[business type]` + `[area]`.

2. Count how many results there are. If there are fewer than fifteen, your market is too small for this challenge — widen the area, not the buyer type.

3. Open the first ten. For each, note whether there is a phone number, whether there are photos, whether the hours are listed, and when the last review was posted.

4. Write one line per business about what is visibly missing. That line is your first message in three weeks' time.

THE CHURN WARNING

More than 80% of federal business licences issued where you live went dormant during 2025. Small businesses open and close constantly, and a dormant licence does not mean the shop is gone — it usually means the paperwork lapsed while the business kept trading. Plan for it in two ways: **never build your income on one client**, and do not treat a business that stops replying as a personal failure.

1.4 Score your three candidates

Score each candidate from 1 to 5 on the six questions below. Highest total wins. If two are within three points, choose the one where you already know somebody.

CRITERION	QUESTION TO ASK YOURSELF	A	B	C
Reachability	Can I get a phone number, a walk-in address or a DM reply within a day?			
Visible problem	Can I see something wrong with their online presence in under five minutes?			
Ability to pay	Does this business visibly take money — customers inside, posted prices, active selling?			
Skill match	Can I already do, or learn in a week, the thing they need?			
Volume	Are there at least fifteen of these businesses within reach?			
Repeat potential	Could this turn into work every month, or is it a one-off?			
Total				

WRITE THE DECISION DOWN

My market is: [buyer type] in [place] who have [problem], and I will reach them by [method].

Write it on paper, photograph it, and set it as your phone wallpaper for thirty days. That sounds excessive. It is the cheapest defence you have against the week-two instinct to change everything.

1.5 The rules for the whole challenge

1. **One market.** No switching before Day 21.
2. **One offer.** You may change the price, the package or the wording. You may not change what you sell.
3. **Daily score.** Five numbers, recorded before you sleep.
4. **Eight conversations a day** from Day 16, without exception.
5. **Money counted when it is in your hand**, not when it is promised.
6. **No fake proof.** Every sample labelled as a sample. Every number you show a client must be true.
7. **Two buffer days.** Use them for illness, exams, family obligations or power cuts — not for a rest from outreach.

DAY 01 **Name three markets**

OBJECTIVE Produce three candidate markets, each with a place, a buyer type, a problem and a way in.

TASK Open Google Maps. Search `[business type] [area]` for three different business types you could plausibly serve. For each search, note how many results appear and whether phone numbers are public. Fill in the shortlist table in section 1.2.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A reader in a regional city searches "restaurant a regional city", "salon a regional city" and "guesthouse a regional city". Restaurants return the most results with public phone numbers and recent reviews; salons return fewer and most have no listing at all; guesthouses return a handful, all with photos but none with prices.

OUTPUT A three-row shortlist table with a real count in each row.

CHECK

- [ ] Each of my three markets names a specific place, not a whole country
- [ ] Each names a buyer type, not "businesses"
- [ ] Each has a count of at least fifteen results
- [ ] I can see a phone number or a walk-in address for most of them

DAY 02 Look for the visible problem

OBJECTIVE Find one specific, visible, fixable problem in each of your three markets.

TASK For each market, open five businesses. Look at: their Google listing (photos, hours, phone), their Facebook or Instagram page (last post date, quality, whether prices appear), and a local classifieds site if they sell online. Write one sentence per business naming what is missing. Five businesses per market, fifteen total.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* "City Fitness Center — Google listing has no photos, no opening hours, and the last review is from 2024. Instagram exists but the last post is nine months old and the bio has no phone number." That is a problem a beginner can fix in a week and charge for.

OUTPUT Fifteen written observations, five per market, each naming one concrete gap.

CHECK

- [ ] Every observation names something I could fix myself
- [ ] None of them says "their marketing is bad" — that is not observable
- [ ] At least five of the fifteen share the same problem (that is your service)

DAY 03 Score and commit

OBJECTIVE Choose one market, write the decision down, and set up the score sheet.

TASK Score your three candidates on the six criteria in section 1.4. Choose the highest total, breaking ties in favour of the market where you already know somebody. Create a Google Sheet named `[Your name] 30-day score` with the five columns from the front matter. Write your market line on paper and photograph it.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A reader scores cafés 24, salons 19 and guesthouses 21. Cafés win on reachability and volume. They write: "Independent cafés in the commercial district and the central district with an Instagram page that has not been posted to in two months; I will reach them through their Google Maps phone number and by walking in."

OUTPUT A scored table, one chosen market, one written market line, one empty score sheet ready for Day 1 entries.

CHECK

- [ ] My score sheet has the five columns and thirty empty rows
- [ ] My market line names a place, a buyer, a problem and a way in
- [ ] I have told one person I am doing this and asked them to check my sheet weekly
- [ ] I have closed the other two markets — no side projects

02

DAYS 4 TO 7

Choose Your Problem and Your Service

Four days to turn an observation into a service you can deliver in under two hours with free tools. This is where most people over-build and quit.

01 From observation to problem statement

02 The service or the product decision

03 Choosing free tools you already have

04 The two-hour delivery test

05 Day 4 to Day 7 cards

SECTION 02

02. Choose Your Problem and Your Service

The problem you sell against must be one the buyer already feels. If you have to convince them the problem exists, you have chosen a project, not a service.

2.1 From observation to problem statement

An observation is what you saw. A problem statement is what it costs them. The difference is the difference between being ignored and being hired.

OBSERVATION (WHAT YOU SAW)	PROBLEM STATEMENT (WHAT IT COSTS THEM)
"Their Instagram has not been posted to in three months."	"Customers who find them on Instagram assume the café has closed, and call to check before coming."
"Their menu photos are from 2023 and have no prices."	"Every table asks the waiter for prices, which slows service at lunch and loses the customers who leave rather than wait."
"Their Google listing has no hours and no photos."	"People searching for a gym nearby skip past them because the listing looks abandoned."
"Their product photos are taken on a dark counter."	"Online buyers cannot see what the fabric actually looks like, so they ask questions instead of ordering."

EXPLAIN A problem statement has three parts: **what is missing**, **who notices**, and **what it costs** in customers, time or money.

SHOW *Example scenario — fictional.* "Riverside Coffee House has an Instagram page with 1,400 followers and no post since March. Tourists and office workers who check the page assume it closed. The owner told me two customers asked if the shop was still open."

DO Write one problem statement for your chosen market, following the three-part shape.

CHECK Can the owner confirm the problem in one sentence without you explaining it? If you have to argue, rewrite it.

2.2 Service or product

You can sell your time or you can sell a file. Both work. They behave very differently, and picking the wrong one for your market is a common first-month mistake.

	SERVICE (YOUR TIME)	PRODUCT (A FILE)
What you sell	Work you do for one buyer	The same file to many buyers
Time to first dollars	Faster — one conversation can close it	Slower — you need a channel and several buyers
Ceiling	Limited by your hours	Limited by your reach

	SERVICE (YOUR TIME)	PRODUCT (A FILE)
Needs an audience?	No. A hundred conversations will do.	Usually yes, or a marketplace where strangers already are

	SERVICE (YOUR TIME)	PRODUCT (A FILE)
Best for this challenge	Yes, for most people in month one	Only if you already have a channel

THE RULE FOR MONTH ONE

Sell a service in the thirty days. A service has one buyer, one conversation and one delivery, which is what a challenge needs. If your market clearly wants a product — study materials, templates, prompt packs — build the product in month two, once you know from real conversations exactly what it should contain.

2.3 Choose free tools you already have

Free plans change without notice, so the rule is: **choose a tool, then verify its current free limits yourself before you design your delivery around it.** Never build a client promise on a feature you have not checked this month.

JOB	FREE TOOL THAT WORKS ON A PHONE	WHAT TO VERIFY
Documents, sheets, forms	Google Docs, Sheets, Forms, Drive	Nothing critical — free tiers have been stable
Graphics, flyers, menus	A free template-based design tool	Which templates and exports the free plan still allows
Short video editing	CapCut, InShot or VN Editor (all free to download on Android; InShot offers ad-supported watermark removal)	Current export resolution and watermark rules
Writing, rewriting, research drafts	A free AI chat tool	Whether the free tier is available for your account and what its limits are
File delivery	Google Drive shared folder, or Telegram	Nothing — but send a link, not twenty attachments
Portfolio	A one-page PDF, or a free single-page site	Nothing — a PDF is enough
Prospect list and score sheet	Google Sheets	Nothing

AVAILABILITY NOTE

Tool availability, free-tier limits and country restrictions vary by account and change over time. Check each tool's current terms before you promise a client anything that depends on it. Where a paid upgrade would help, treat it as OPTIONAL — every core task in this challenge has a free path.

2.4 The two-hour delivery test

Before you offer anything, prove you can deliver it in under two hours with the tools you have, on the connection you have.

1. **Pick one fictional client**
   Invent a business in your market — a café, a salon, a gym. Give it a name and a street.

1 **Do the work once, timed**

Make the actual deliverable. Five social posts, a two-page menu, a cleaned-up product photo set. Time yourself honestly.

1 **Record the real duration**

If it took four hours, your price must reflect four hours. If it took six, shrink the offer until it takes two.

2 **Note what broke**

Slow uploads, a tool limit, a missing font, a bad photo. Each break becomes either a rule in your process or a line in your scope document.

LOW-BANDWIDTH RULE

Median fixed download speed where you live is around 9.4 Mbps and average mobile download around 26.6 Mbps, but documented worst-case freelancer speeds fall as low as 98 Kb/s between 16:00 and 24:00. Design every deliverable to be small: **720p video, compressed images, PDF under 5 MB, links instead of attachments, and uploads scheduled before 16:00 where possible.**

DAY 04 Write the problem statement

OBJECTIVE Convert your fifteen observations into one problem statement your market already feels.

TASK Group your fifteen observations by theme. The theme that appears most often is your service. Write the problem statement in three parts: what is missing, who notices, what it costs.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Eleven of fifteen cafés had not posted in over two months. Problem statement: "Cafés that stop posting look closed to the customers who check Instagram before choosing where to eat, and the owner has no time to restart."

OUTPUT One problem statement, written out in full, in the three-part shape.

CHECK

- [ ] My problem statement names what is missing
- [ ] It names who notices
- [ ] It names what it costs them
- [ ] It does not mention my skill or my service

DAY 05 Decide service, not product

OBJECTIVE Commit to one service for the thirty days, and write down what the client receives.

TASK Write one sentence: "I help [buyer] to [outcome] by delivering [specific thing]." Then list the exact items in the delivery: how many posts, how many pages, what format, what file size.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* "I help independent cafés in the commercial district look open and busy online, by delivering twelve social posts a month — six photographs with text overlays and six short video clips — plus a one-page posting calendar, supplied as a shared Google Drive folder."

OUTPUT A one-sentence service description and a written list of what is included.

CHECK

- [ ] My service names a buyer, not "businesses"
- [ ] It names an outcome the buyer wants
- [ ] It names a countable deliverable
- [ ] I have not included a second service "as well"

DAY 06 Set up your tools

OBJECTIVE Have every tool installed, logged in and tested before you promise work.

TASK Install and log in to: Google Drive with a folder called `Clients`; your design tool; your video editor; Telegram; a free AI chat tool if you will use one. Test one export from each. Note the free-tier limits you find on the page where you found them.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A reader in a regional city discovers the free design tier will not export at print resolution for a menu. They adjust: design at screen size for social, and for print work they charge for the time to build the file and send it as a PDF sized for the printer, testing one page with the print shop first.

OUTPUT A working tool set, one test export from each, and a written note of any limits you found.

CHECK

- [ ] Every tool opens and exports on my phone
- [ ] My Drive folder structure exists
- [ ] I know the current free limits of each tool I plan to rely on
- [ ] Nothing in my delivery plan depends on a paid feature

DAY 07 Pass the two-hour test

OBJECTIVE Deliver the whole service once, for a fictional client, inside two hours.

TASK Invent a client in your market. Do the complete deliverable, timed. Record the real duration. Write down every point where you got stuck or slowed down.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* "Eastside Motors" — a fictional garage in your city. Twelve social posts took three hours forty minutes, mostly because sourcing usable photos took two hours. Decision: add a line to the offer requiring the client to supply photos, or charge an extra $5 to shoot them on site.

OUTPUT One finished deliverable, one honest duration, one written list of what slowed you down.

CHECK

- [ ] I finished a complete deliverable, not a sample of one
- [ ] I timed it instead of guessing
- [ ] My price will reflect the real duration
- [ ] I have either fixed or scoped out every bottleneck I found

03

DAYS 8 TO 12

Build the Offer and the Proof

Five days to write an offer somebody can say yes to, price it in dollars, and build three labelled samples so a stranger is not your first experiment.

01 The offer formula

02 Pricing your first offer

03 The three sample projects

04 Your working profile

05 Day 8 to Day 12 cards

SECTION 03

03. Build the Offer and the Proof

An offer is not a description of your skills. It is a sentence a busy person can say yes to without thinking hard.

3.1 The offer formula

Every offer in this challenge is built from the same five parts. Miss one and the buyer has to do work to understand you, and buyers do not do work.

1	2	3	4	5
WHAT YOU DO	FOR WHOM	WHAT THEY GET	WHAT IT COSTS	HOW LONG IT TAKES

COPY-READY: OFFER TEMPLATE

I help **[buyer type]** in **[place]** who **[problem]**.

For **[price] USD** I will deliver **[countable items]**, ready in **[time]**.

You get: **[list the files, formats and quantities]**.

You need to give me: **[photos, logo, prices, access — be specific]**.

If it is not right, I will revise it **[number]** time(s) at no extra cost.

EXPLAIN The last two lines do more work than the first three. Telling the client what *they* must supply prevents the project stalling for two weeks. Naming the revision limit prevents an endless loop.

SHOW *Example scenario — fictional.* "I help independent cafés in the commercial district and the central district that have stopped posting on Instagram. For $28 a month I will deliver twelve posts — six photo posts with text, six short videos, plus a one-page calendar — ready within five working days of getting your photos. You send me 20 phone photos of the café and the menu; I do the rest. Two rounds of changes included."

DO Write your own offer using the template. Keep it under 90 words. If it is longer, you are explaining instead of offering.

CHECK Read your offer to somebody who knows nothing about your work. If they can tell you what they would receive and what it costs, it passes.

3.2 Pricing your first offer

There is no published local rate card for these services. Anyone who tells you there is one is guessing. What you have instead is a method: price from your hours, then adjust for the buyer.

PRICING FROM YOUR HOURS — A WORKED EXAMPLE

```
Delivery took 3 hours × your target hourly rate
If you want $2.50 per hour → 3 × 400 = $8 floor
```

```
Add 30% for revisions, messages and admin → about $10
```

Then round to a number that sounds like a price, not a calculation: 1,500 or 1,800. The hourly rate is yours to choose; start where you can say the number out loud without flinching.

Now adjust for the buyer. The same deliverable is worth different amounts to a kiosk and to a hotel with forty rooms.

SIGNAL	PRICE EFFECT	WHY
They already pay for marketing, printing or a page manager	Up	There is an existing budget line. You are replacing a cost, not creating one.
They have a customer queue	Up	Your work touches revenue immediately.
They are a single-person shop with no staff	Down	The owner is the buyer and the budget is personal money.
They asked you first	Up	Inbound interest is worth more than your outreach.
They want it live before a specific date	Up	Urgency is a real cost to you.
They are a friend or family	Decide before you start	Discount the price, never the scope. Free work for relatives rarely ends well.

THE THREE-TIER LADDER

Always quote three options, not one. A single price invites a yes/no answer; three prices invite a choice.

Starter — the smallest useful version. **Standard** — the version you actually want to sell, priced about twice Starter. **Monthly** — the same as Standard, delivered every month, at a small discount to the one-off price.

The middle option is chosen most often. That is why you put the package you want to deliver in the middle.

3.3 The three sample projects

You cannot show client work you do not have. You can show clearly-labelled sample work that demonstrates exactly what a buyer would receive. The labelling is not a legal formality — it is the reason the samples are credible.

THE LABELLING RULE

Every sample carries the words **"Sample — created by [your name] for demonstration. Not client work."** Put it on the image itself, in the corner, small but readable. Put it in the file name. Put it in the folder description.

Never imply a sample was paid work. Never use a real business's logo in a sample without permission. Never take a real business's photos and present a redesign as though they commissioned it.

SAMPLE	WHAT IT PROVES	TIME TO BUILD
1. Before and after	That you can see what is wrong and fix it. Take a real local business's public page, show its current state, then show your improved version clearly labelled as an unsolicited concept.	2 hours
2. A full deliverable for a fictional client	That you can produce the whole package, not one piece. Use an invented business — *Lakeview Style House*, *Highland Tour Link*, *City Fitness Center* — and deliver the exact contents of your Standard package.	3 hours
3. A process one-pager	That you are organised. One page: what you need from the client, what you deliver, how long it takes, how revisions work.	1 hour

COPY-READY: PERMISSION MESSAGE BEFORE USING A REAL BUSINESS IN A SAMPLE

Selam [name], I am a [your service] working with [business type] in [area]. I made a sample redesign of your [page / menu / listing] as a practice piece. It is clearly marked as a sample and not as your work.

May I show it in my portfolio? If you would rather I did not, I will remove it today — just say so.

Either way, I would be glad to send you the file to keep.

3.4 Your working profile

You do not need a website. You need one place a stranger can look and understand what you do in fifteen seconds.

The minimum viable profile

- A clean email address: `firstname.lastname@gmail.com`, not a nickname from school.
- A one-page PDF portfolio in a shared Drive folder with view access on.
- A Telegram account used for work, with your real name and a profile photo.
- An Instagram or Facebook account only if your market actually looks there.
- A signature block with your name, what you do, and one contact method.

What you do not need

- A logo. A clean text name is better than a bad logo.
- A website. A PDF and a phone number convert better in this market.
- A business licence to start. Wallet and bank transfers work for local clients without one.
- A company name. Use your own name until a client asks for an invoice with a company on it.
- Paid tools. Nothing in this challenge requires one.

DAY 08 Write the offer

OBJECTIVE

One complete offer, under 90 words, with all five parts present.

TASK

Fill in the offer template. Then cut it until it is under 90 words. Read it aloud twice.

EXAMPLE

Example scenario — fictional. A reader serving guesthouses in a regional city writes: "I help guesthouses near the lake that have no photos on Google. For $19 I deliver a Google Business Profile set-up: 15 photos edited, description, hours, phone, and directions — live within four days. You send 20 phone photos; I do the rest."

OUTPUT

A written offer, 90 words or fewer, containing buyer, problem, deliverable, price and time.

CHECK

- [ ] It names a specific buyer
- [ ] It names a countable deliverable
- [ ] It states a price in dollars
- [ ] It states a delivery time
- [ ] It says what the client must supply
- [ ] It is under 90 words

DAY 09 Price it three ways

OBJECTIVE

A three-tier price ladder built from your real delivery time, not from a guess.

TASK

Take the duration you recorded on Day 07. Calculate your hourly floor. Add 30% for revision and admin. Set Starter at the smallest useful version, Standard at roughly twice Starter, and Monthly at Standard minus about 15%. Write all three with what each includes.

EXAMPLE

Example scenario — fictional. Delivery took 3 hours. Floor $8, with revision allowance about $10. The reader sets: **Starter** $9 for 5 posts; **Standard** $19 for 12 posts; **Monthly** $16 per month for 12 posts. All three are examples, not market rates.

OUTPUT

Three priced packages, each with a written contents list.

CHECK

- [ ] Every price traces back to my real delivery time
- [ ] Standard is the one I want to sell, and it is in the middle
- [ ] I can say every number out loud without hesitating
- [ ] No package prices below my hourly floor

DAY 10 Build sample one

OBJECTIVE A before-and-after sample, honestly labelled.

TASK Pick a real business in your market. Screenshot the current state of their public page or listing. Build your improved version. Put both side by side. Label it "Sample — created by [name] for demonstration. Not client work." Send the permission message from 3.3 if you intend to show it publicly.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A reader in a regional city screenshots a real café's Google listing — no photos, no hours — and builds a version with six photos, correct hours, a description and a price range on the menu image. The listing stays unedited; only the sample changes.

OUTPUT One labelled before-and-after image, saved as PNG, under 1 MB.

CHECK

- [ ] The label is on the image, not only in the file name
- [ ] I did not touch the real business's live page
- [ ] I did not imply it was paid work
- [ ] I sent the permission message if I plan to publish it

DAY 11 Build sample two

OBJECTIVE A complete Standard package delivered for a fictional client.

TASK Invent a business — give it a name, a street, a type. Deliver everything in your Standard tier. Time yourself. This sample becomes the thing you show when a prospect asks "what would I get?".

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* "Central Coffee House", a fictional café. Twelve posts: six photo posts with prices and hours, six 15-second clips of the roastery. Plus a one-page calendar. Total build time: two hours fifty minutes.

OUTPUT A full deliverable set for a fictional client, in one Drive folder, labelled as sample work.

CHECK

- [ ] The complete package exists, not a partial one
- [ ] A stranger could understand what they would receive by looking at it
- [ ] Every file is named clearly and is small enough to send on a weak connection
- [ ] It is labelled as sample work

DAY 12 Assemble the profile

OBJECTIVE A single link a stranger can open, understand in fifteen seconds, and act on.

TASK Build the process one-pager (sample three). Put all three samples in one Drive folder with view access on. Write your email signature. Create the Telegram work account if you do not have one. Test opening the folder link on a phone that is not yours.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* The folder contains: `01-before-after-sample.png`, `02-full-package-sample/`, `03-how-i-work.pdf`. The link opens in under five seconds on a mid-range Android phone.

OUTPUT One folder link, one process PDF, one email signature, one tested phone.

CHECK

- [ ] The link opens without asking for permission
- [ ] The folder is under 20 MB total
- [ ] The first file explains what I do
- [ ] Every sample is labelled

04

DAYS 13 TO 15

Build the Prospect List

Three days to turn your market into forty named businesses with a phone number, a contact person and one written observation each.

01 What qualifies as a prospect

02 The Google Maps sweep

03 The tracker sheet

04 A worked example of five rows

05 Day 13 to Day 15 cards

SECTION 04

04. Build the Prospect List

Forty named businesses. Not forty ideas, not "cafés in Addis". Forty rows with a name, a phone number and one sentence about what is wrong.

4.1 What qualifies as a prospect

A business belongs on your list only if it passes three tests.

01 Reachable

You have a phone number, a walk-in address, or an active DM inbox. If you cannot start a conversation, it is not a prospect.

02 Visibly trading

They have customers, prices, recent photos or recent reviews. A dormant licence does not disqualify them — a shop with no customers does.

03 One written problem

You can name, in one line, something specific you would fix. No observation, no row.

4.2 The Google Maps sweep

This is the whole method. Done properly it produces forty qualified prospects in about three hours.

1. **Search one term in one area**

   Example: `café the commercial district`. Use the real district names — the commercial district, the central district, the eastern district, the old town, the northern district, the western district, the outer district, the industrial district, the market district, the busiest district. In regional cities use the neighbourhood or the main road.

2. **Open each result and record six fields**

   Name, area, phone, contact person if shown, what is visibly missing, and the date you looked. Six fields, thirty seconds each.

3. **Stop at forty**

   Do not collect two hundred. Forty is enough to run twenty days of outreach at eight conversations a day, with room for a second pass.

4. **Sort by how easy the fix is**

   The business with the biggest visible gap is not always the best first target. The best first target is the one whose problem you can fix in one afternoon with the tools you already have.

WHERE ELSE TO FIND PROSPECTS

a local classifieds site shows you who is actively selling and how they present themselves — useful when your offer is about product photos or listings. **an online business directory** lets you browse around thirty categories and filter by city. **an online business directory** has larger companies and importers. **Telegram and Facebook groups** show you owners asking for help in public. **Walking the street** remains the strongest method in regional cities, where a face-to-face introduction beats a message.

4.3 The tracker sheet

One Google Sheet. These columns, in this order.

COLUMN	WHAT GOES IN IT
#	1 to 40
Business name	Exactly as it appears on their listing
Type	Café, gym, salon, guesthouse, and so on
Area	Sub-city, neighbourhood or street
Phone	With the country code written the way you will dial it
Contact person	Name if you have it, otherwise "owner"
Observation	One line: what is visibly missing
Channel	Call, walk-in, Telegram, Instagram DM
First contact date	The day you actually sent or made it
Status	New / Contacted / Follow-up 1 / Follow-up 2 / Replied / Proposal / Won / Lost
Next action date	The date you will next touch this row. Never leave it blank on a contacted row.
Notes	What they said, in their words

The "Next action date" column is what separates a tracker from a list. A row without a next action is a row you have abandoned.

4.4 A worked example of five rows

Example scenario — fictional. All five businesses below are invented.

#	BUSINESS	AREA	OBSERVATION	CHANNEL	STATUS
1	Riverside Coffee House	the commercial district, your city	Instagram last posted 4 months ago; bio has no phone	Walk-in	New
2	City Fitness Center	the central district, your city	Google listing has no photos and no opening hours	Phone	New
3	Lakeview Style House	a regional city	a local classifieds site listings use dark photos on a counter; no size chart	Telegram	New
4	Highland Tour Link	a regional city	Facebook page has 2023 prices and no reviews	Facebook DM	New
5	Central Coffee House	a regional city	Menu photos unreadable on a phone screen	Walk-in	New

WRITE THE OBSERVATION BEFORE YOU WRITE THE MESSAGE

The observation is what makes the message personal. If you write your messages first and then look for businesses that fit, the personalisation will be generic and the reply rate will show it. Fill the observation column for all forty rows before Day 16.

DAY 13 Build the sheet and the first fifteen

OBJECTIVE A working tracker with twelve columns and the first fifteen qualified rows.

TASK Create the sheet with the twelve column headers from 4.3. Run a Google Maps sweep in one area and one business type until you have fifteen rows, each with a phone number and a written observation.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A reader searches `café the commercial district` and `café the central district`, opens 24 results, and qualifies 15. Nine are filtered out: three had no phone number, four looked closed, two had posted within the last week and had no visible gap.

OUTPUT Fifteen completed rows, each with a phone number and an observation.

CHECK

- [ ] All twelve columns exist
- [ ] Every row has a phone number or a walk-in address
- [ ] Every row has a written observation in my own words
- [ ] No row is a duplicate

DAY 14 Finish the forty

OBJECTIVE Forty qualified rows.

TASK Widen the sweep: two more areas, or two more business types inside your market. Add twenty-five more rows. Then sort the whole sheet by how easy the fix is.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A reader in a regional city adds `guesthouse a regional city` and `gym a regional city` and reaches 41 rows. The easiest ten are those needing only a Google listing update with photos they can shoot in one afternoon.

OUTPUT Forty-plus rows, sorted, with the ten easiest marked.

CHECK

- [ ] At least forty rows
- [ ] At least ten rows where I could complete the fix in one afternoon
- [ ] Spread across more than one area or more than one business type
- [ ] Every row still has an observation

DAY 15 Rehearse and prepare

OBJECTIVE Two messages written and rehearsed, and a schedule for eight conversations a day.

TASK Write your first message and your walk-in opener using the scripts in section 05. Say both out loud ten times. Book two fixed hours a day in your phone calendar for outreach, and decide which channel you will use for which business type.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A reader blocks 09:00–10:00 and 17:00–18:00 daily. Mornings are for walk-ins on the way to class; evenings are for messages. Calls are reserved for businesses that answered a message.

OUTPUT Two rehearsed scripts, two daily calendar blocks, one channel plan.

CHECK

- [ ] I can say the first message without reading it
- [ ] The two daily blocks are in my calendar, not in my head
- [ ] I know which ten rows I will contact first
- [ ] My offer, price ladder and profile link are all ready to send

05

DAYS 16 TO 21

Outreach

Six days of conversations. This is the section people skip, and skipping it is the only reliable way to fail this challenge.

01 The daily quota and why it is eight

02 The first message

03 The walk-in

04 Follow-up, silence and refusals

05 Every script you need

06 Day 16 to Day 21 cards

SECTION 05

05. Outreach

Eight conversations a day, for six days, is forty-eight conversations. That is the engine of this challenge. Everything else is preparation for it.

5.1 The daily quota, and why it is eight

Eight is not a magic number. It is small enough to do on a bad day and large enough to produce replies by the end of the week. If you send two a day you will conclude the market is dead before you have met it.

WHY VOLUME MATTERS MORE THAN POLISH IN WEEK THREE

```
8 conversations × 6 days = 48 conversations
At a reply rate of one in five → about 10 replies
At one proposal per three replies → about 3 proposals
```

Illustrative arithmetic to size your effort, not a forecast. Reply rates vary enormously with market, channel and message quality.

TWO MISTAKES THAT KILL WEEK THREE

One: sending the same message to all forty rows. It reads as bulk mail and gets treated as bulk mail.

Two: sending two messages, receiving no reply, and spending the rest of the day rewriting the plan. **The plan is not the problem. Ten messages is the problem.**

5.2 The first message

A first message has four jobs: prove you looked at them specifically, name the problem you saw, offer something small, and make replying easy. It has one job it must not do: ask for a big commitment.

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE — LOCAL BUSINESS (TELEGRAM, INSTAGRAM DM OR FACEBOOK)

Selam [name or business name]. I was looking at [specific thing you looked at] and noticed [the observation, in one line].

I do [your service] for [business type] in [area]. I already made a small example for you — [link to the one relevant sample].

No charge and no obligation. If it is useful, I can explain how it would work for [business name] in three lines.

COPY-READY: FIRST MESSAGE — PHONE CALL OPENER

"Selam, is this [business name]? My name is [name]. I work with [business type] in [area] on [service].

I noticed [observation] on your [listing / page]. Do you have two minutes, or would it be better if I sent you a message with a picture?"

COPY-READY: WALK-IN OPENER

"Selam. My name is [name], I live nearby and I work with [business type] on [service].

I am not selling anything today. I noticed [observation] and I made a small example — can I show you on my phone for one minute? If you are not interested I will leave you my number and go."

EXPLAIN Personalisation is not flattery. It is evidence that you looked. One true, specific detail outperforms three compliments.

SHOW Weak: "Your café looks amazing, I can help you grow on social media." Strong: "Your Instagram has 1,400 followers but the last post was in March, and your bio has no phone number — I made a three-post example that shows what a restart would look like."

DO Customise the first line of every message using the observation column in your tracker. Ninety seconds per message is the target.

CHECK Could this message have been sent to a different business without changing anything? If yes, rewrite it.

5.3 Follow-up, silence and refusals

Most replies do not arrive after the first message. They arrive after the second or third. Silence is not rejection; it is usually a busy person who meant to reply.

CONTACT	WHEN	WHAT IT SAYS
First message	Day of first contact	The observation, the sample, the small ask.
Follow-up 1	3 days later	One new piece of value. Not "just checking in".
Follow-up 2	7 days after that	A direct, easy question with two possible answers.
Final message	10 days after that	Close the loop politely so you can stop thinking about it.

COPY-READY: FOLLOW-UP 1 (3 DAYS)

Selam [name] — one more thing that might be useful. I checked [specific thing] and [one concrete new observation].

Still happy to explain in three lines whenever it suits you.

COPY-READY: FOLLOW-UP 2 (7 DAYS LATER)

Selam [name]. Should I close this for now, or would you like me to send the example and the price?

Either answer is fine — I just do not want to keep appearing in your messages if it is not useful.

COPY-READY: FINAL MESSAGE

Selam [name]. I will stop here so I am not taking up your time. The example is yours to keep — it is at [link]. If you ever want it finished, my number is [number].

Wishing [business name] a good season.

5.4 Handling the four answers you will actually get

COPY-READY: "HOW MUCH?"

Thank you for asking. Three options, so you can pick what suits:

- **Starter** — [price] USD: [smallest package]
- **Standard** — [price] USD: [main package]
- **Monthly** — [price] USD per month: the same as Standard, delivered every month.

All three include [number] rounds of changes. Which one fits what you had in mind?

COPY-READY: "THAT IS TOO EXPENSIVE"

Understood — thank you for saying so plainly. Two options: I can reduce the scope rather than the price, so you get [smaller deliverable] for [lower price] USD, or we can start with the Starter package and add more later once you have seen the result.

Which would be more useful?

COPY-READY: "WE ALREADY HAVE SOMEONE"

That is good to hear. I will not try to replace anybody.

One thing you might find useful: [one specific observation about something their current provider is not doing]. If that is ever worth fixing, I am easy to find — [contact].

COPY-READY: "SEND ME YOUR PRICE LIST"

Here it is: [attach the one-page price list as a PDF or image]

Most [business type] start with the Standard package. If you tell me which of the three you are leaning towards, I can tell you honestly whether it is the right fit for [business name].

THE REJECTION ARITHMETIC

Forty-eight conversations producing three proposals and one client is a normal first run, not a failure. That means roughly ninety-six per cent of your messages will not produce a sale. **Plan for that number before you start, so that the eleventh "no" lands as data instead of as a verdict on you.**

DAY 16 **First eight conversations**

OBJECTIVE Eight real conversations started with eight real businesses.

TASK Start with the ten easiest rows. Send or make eight contacts using the first-message script, personalising the opening line from your observation column. Update the tracker immediately: first contact date, channel, status, next action date.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Four walk-ins on the way to class, three Telegram messages, one phone call. One café owner says "come back after a national holiday" — that becomes a next action date, not a dead row.

OUTPUT Eight rows moved from New to Contacted, each with a next action date.

CHECK

- [ ] Eight contacts made, not seven
- [ ] No two messages are identical
- [ ] Every contacted row has a next action date
- [ ] Score sheet updated with conversations and replies

DAY 17 Eight more, and the first follow-ups

OBJECTIVE Sixteen conversations total.

TASK Eight new contacts. Then check every row contacted three days ago and send follow-up 1 with one new piece of value. Update the tracker.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A reader notices that the four cafés contacted on Day 16 all have the same missing item — no opening hours on Google. Follow-up 1 includes a screenshot showing exactly where the hours would appear.

OUTPUT Sixteen contacted rows, first follow-ups sent, tracker current.

CHECK

- [ ] Eight new conversations started
- [ ] Every Day-16 row without a reply has received a follow-up
- [ ] Follow-ups contain new information, not "just checking in"
- [ ] Score sheet updated

DAY 18 Volume day

OBJECTIVE Twenty-four conversations total, and your first honest read on reply rate.

TASK Eight new contacts. Then calculate your reply rate from the sheet: replies divided by conversations. If it is below one in ten, change the message, not the market. Try a different opening — question instead of statement, or voice note instead of text.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Sixteen contacts, one reply — about one in sixteen. The reader switches the opening from a statement to a question: "Is your Instagram still active?" Two replies arrive the same evening.

OUTPUT Twenty-four contacted rows, a calculated reply rate, and one message variation tested.

CHECK

- [ ] Eight new conversations started
- [ ] I calculated my actual reply rate instead of guessing
- [ ] I tested one variation rather than rewriting everything
- [ ] Score sheet updated

DAY 19 Thirty-two conversations

OBJECTIVE Thirty-two conversations and the first proposals sent.

TASK Eight new contacts. Send follow-up 2 to anyone contacted ten days ago. For anyone who has replied with interest, send the three-tier price message from 5.4 and record it as a proposal.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Three owners have replied positively. Two receive the three-tier message. One asks for a call; the reader schedules it for the next morning and writes the price into the calendar note so they do not fumble the number.

OUTPUT Thirty-two contacted rows and at least one proposal sent.

CHECK

- [ ] Eight new conversations started
- [ ] Every interested reply has received a price
- [ ] I recorded proposals separately from replies
- [ ] Score sheet updated

DAY 20 Forty, and close one

OBJECTIVE Forty conversations and one client closed, or one clear reason why not.

TASK Eight new contacts. Then go back to every warm row and ask for the decision directly: "Would you like me to start on [date]?" A closing question with a date in it converts far better than "let me know".

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A café owner who has been saying "later" for a week is asked: "Would you like me to start Monday and have the first five posts up by Wednesday?" The owner says yes, and asks for a mobile wallet number.

OUTPUT Forty contacted rows and either one closed client or a written list of the specific objections you heard.

CHECK

- [ ] Forty conversations started in total
- [ ] Every warm row has received a direct closing question
- [ ] Every refusal is written down in the client's own words
- [ ] Score sheet updated

DAY 21 Buffer and review

OBJECTIVE Catch up, and make the one allowed decision about your market.

TASK Catch up on any missed conversations or follow-ups. Then review the sheet honestly. If you have fewer than three replies from forty conversations, you may change **one** thing: the market, the offer, or the message. Not two. Write down which one you changed and why.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Forty conversations, two replies, no proposals. The reader changes the offer, not the market: instead of twelve posts a month — which felt expensive — they offer a one-time "Google listing fix" for $9, which is easier to say yes to. Three replies arrive within two days.

OUTPUT A clean tracker with no overdue follow-ups, and one written decision.

CHECK

- [ ] No row is more than three days overdue for its next action
- [ ] I changed exactly one thing, or nothing
- [ ] I wrote down the reason
- [ ] Score sheet has 21 rows

06

DAYS 22 TO 24

Proposals, Negotiation and Closing

Three days to turn interest into a signed piece of work: the proposal, the price conversation, the deposit, and the second-chance follow-up.

01 The five-part proposal

02 The price conversation

03 The deposit

04 Closing without pressure

05 Day 22 to Day 24 cards

SECTION 06

06. Proposals, Negotiation and Closing

A proposal is not a document. It is a short message that makes the next step obvious. If the client has to think about what happens after reading it, it has failed.

6.1 The five-part proposal

Five parts, in this order, in under 150 words. Send it as a message with one attachment — a single-page PDF or image — not as a long email.

PART	WHAT IT SAYS	EXAMPLE LINE
1. Their situation	Repeat the problem in their words	"You said customers call to ask if the café is still open."
2. What you will do	The countable deliverable	"Twelve posts a month, plus a posting calendar."
3. What it costs	The three-tier ladder	"Starter 1,500 / Standard 3,000 / Monthly 2,500 per month."
4. What you need from them	The exact inputs	"Twenty phone photos and the prices. That is all."
5. The next step	One action with a date	"If you want to start, send 50% and I will begin Monday."

COPY-READY: FULL PROPOSAL MESSAGE

Selam [name]. Here is the proposal for [business name].

Where you are: [their problem, in their words].

What I will do: [countable deliverable], delivered within [time] of receiving your photos.

Three options:
• Starter — [price] USD: [contents]
• Standard — [price] USD: [contents]
• Monthly — [price] USD/month: Standard, every month

I need from you: [exact inputs].

To start: reply "start" and send 50% to [wallet or bank detail]. I will begin the next working day and send you the first pieces within [time].

6.2 The price conversation

Most beginners lose deals at the moment they say the number, not before it. Three habits fix that.

01 Say the number, then stop

Do not fill the silence. Do not add "but we can negotiate" or "I am flexible". Say the price and wait for their answer. The silence feels much longer to you than to them.

02 Never discount the price

Reduce the scope instead. "I can do five posts for 1,500 instead of twelve for 3,000." A discounted price teaches the client that your first number was not real.

03 Give three options

Three prices turn a yes/no into a choice. Put the package you actually want to deliver in the middle.

THE WORDS THAT HOLD A PRICE

"That is the price for that scope." · "I can reduce the scope, but I cannot reduce the price for the same work." · "Let me know which of the three suits you and I will start."

None of these is aggressive. All three are clearer than "it is negotiable".

6.3 The deposit

Ask for 50% before you start, every time, including for friends. A deposit is not distrust; it is how small work gets done without either side feeling exposed.

COPY-READY: HOW TO ASK FOR A DEPOSIT WITHOUT SOUNDING RUDE

"So that we both know the project is real, I ask for half at the start and half when you are happy with the delivery. That way you are not paying fully for something you have not seen, and I am not doing three days of work on a maybe."

CONFIRM THE MONEY BEFORE YOU DELIVER

Read the balance in your own wallet or bank app. A screenshot from a client is not payment — screenshots can be edited, and a pending transfer can fail. **Deliver when the money is visible in your account, not before.** Say this politely up front so it is a rule rather than a suspicion: "I start as soon as the transfer shows in my wallet."

6.4 Closing without pressure

Closing is not persuading. It is removing the last small uncertainty and giving one clear next step.

— **Use a date.** "Would you like me to start Monday?" converts better than "let me know".

— **Make the first step small.** Starter, not Standard, for a hesitant client. You can upsell in month two.

— **Answer the real objection.** "Too expensive" usually means "I am not sure this will work". Reply with the smallest paid version, not a discount.

— **Stop at three follow-ups.** Then close the loop politely and move on. The final message in section 05 exists for this.

— **Ask for the decision, not for permission.** "Shall I send the payment details?" is a closing question. "Let me know if you are interested" is not.

DAY 22 Send the proposals

OBJECTIVE Every warm conversation gets a five-part proposal.

TASK Go through the tracker. For every row with a positive reply and no price yet, send the proposal message with the three-tier ladder and one attachment. Record the status as Proposal.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Four warm rows. Three receive proposals the same morning. The fourth asked for a call, so the reader writes the three prices on a card and keeps it beside the phone.

OUTPUT Every warm row has a written price in front of it.

CHECK

- [ ] Every proposal names a countable deliverable
- [ ] Every proposal has three prices, not one
- [ ] Every proposal states what the client must supply
- [ ] Every proposal ends with one dated next step
- [ ] Score sheet updated with proposals sent

DAY 23 Handle the answers

OBJECTIVE Every proposal answered, every objection recorded in the client's own words.

TASK Reply to every response using the scripts in 5.4. When someone says it is too expensive, reduce the scope, never the price. Write every refusal into the Notes column verbatim — the exact phrase they used.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Two refusals: one says "we do this ourselves", one says "3,000 is too much for one month". The second is not a rejection of the service — it is a signal that the Starter package should be the opening offer next time.

OUTPUT Every proposal answered, every refusal written down word for word.

CHECK

- [ ] No proposal is left unanswered
- [ ] I reduced scope rather than price
- [ ] Every refusal is recorded in their words, not my summary
- [ ] Score sheet updated

DAY 24 Close one and take the deposit

OBJECTIVE One client closed and a deposit visible in your own account.

TASK Ask every warm row the dated closing question. When somebody agrees, send your payment details immediately and ask them to confirm when the transfer shows. Do not start work until you can see the money.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A gym owner replies "start". The reader sends their a mobile wallet number, receives $9 of a $19 Standard package, screenshots the confirmation in their own app, and sends the onboarding message the same evening.

OUTPUT Either one closed client with a deposit received, or a written list of every objection heard across forty-eight conversations.

CHECK

- [ ] I asked a dated closing question of every warm row
- [ ] I did not start work before the money appeared
- [ ] The client knows exactly what happens next and when
- [ ] Score sheet updated with any dollars collected

07

DAYS 25 TO 28

Delivery

Four days to do the work well enough that the client pays the balance, says something nice about you, and comes back next month.

01 The onboarding message

02 The scope document

03 Delivering on a slow connection

04 The delivery message

05 Day 25 to Day 28 cards

SECTION 07

07. Delivery

Delivery is where a first client becomes a repeat client, or where a one-off job becomes the last job. The difference is almost never the quality of the work. It is the clarity of the process.

7.1 The onboarding message

Send this within an hour of receiving the deposit. It removes every remaining uncertainty in one message.

COPY-READY: ONBOARDING MESSAGE

Thank you [name] — I have received the deposit and I am starting.

What happens next:

1. You send me [exact inputs] by [date].
2. I send the first pieces by [date] so you can see the direction early.
3. I deliver everything by [date].
4. You tell me what to change — up to [number] rounds are included.
5. When you are happy, you send the balance of [amount] USD and I hand over the files.

If anything is unclear at any point, message me here. I answer between [hours].

7.2 The scope document

One page, sent with the onboarding message. It exists to protect both of you from the slow drift that turns a three-day job into a three-week one.

COPY-READY: SCOPE DOCUMENT

Project: [name] for [business]

What is included: [countable list, with formats]

What is not included: [printing, paid ads, extra platforms, photography, weekend work, translation, anything you are not doing]

What I need from you: [inputs], by [date]

Timeline: start [date] · first draft [date] · final delivery [date]

Revisions: [number] rounds included. Further rounds are [amount] USD each.

Payment: [amount] USD deposit received · [amount] USD on delivery

If something changes: message me and we will agree a new date in writing.

WHY THE "NOT INCLUDED" LINE MATTERS

The most common reason a first project goes wrong is not disagreement — it is that the client assumed something was included. Printing. A second platform. Two extra posts. A weekend change. Writing those exclusions down, politely, at the start prevents the conversation that would otherwise happen at the end.

7.3 Delivering on a slow connection

Your internet is part of the deliverable. Design for it.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO INSTEAD
A large file will not upload	Compress images to under 300 KB each; export video at 720p; split a big PDF into two files. Send a link, never twenty attachments.
Speeds collapse in the evening	Documented worst-case local freelancer speeds fall as low as 98 Kb/s between 16:00 and 24:00. Upload in the morning, or queue the upload and let it run.
The connection drops mid-upload	Upload to a Drive folder rather than a chat. Drive resumes; a message attachment does not.
The client cannot open what you sent	Send a JPG or PNG preview alongside the PDF. Assume they are reading on a phone with a small data bundle.
A call is impossible	Send a two-minute voice note instead of scheduling a video call. It works on a weak connection and is often answered faster.

FILE NAMING THAT MAKES YOU LOOK PROFESSIONAL

`2026-09-14_bolebeans_instagram_12posts_v1.zip`

Date first, client, what it is, version. When the client has four versions in their downloads folder, the one with the date and the version number is the one they open. This costs nothing and it is the single cheapest way to look organised.

7.4 The delivery message

COPY-READY: DELIVERY MESSAGE

Selam **[name]** — everything is ready.

Folder: **[link]**

Inside you will find: **[list the files and what each is for]**.

Three things you can do with it today: **[one specific action per file — post this one Tuesday morning, print this one as A3, send this one to your printer]**.

Have a look and tell me what to change — **[number]** rounds are included. If it is all good, the balance is **[amount] USD** to **[wallet or bank detail]**, and I will send the final files plus a short note on how to keep it going.

EXPLAIN Telling the client what to *do* with each file is what separates a delivery from a download. Most small businesses receive good work and never use it because nobody told them the next action.

SHOW Weak: "Here are your 12 posts." Strong: "Post the coffee-roasting clip on Tuesday at 08:00 — that is when your customers check their phones. Use the price image as the pinned post. The menu PDF is sized for A3 printing; your printer will know what to do with it."

DO Write one instruction line for every file in your delivery.

CHECK Could the client follow your instructions without asking a single question? If not, add a line.

7.5 Over-deliver once, then stop

Add one small extra to the first delivery — a bonus post, a cleaned-up logo file, a printed handout. It costs you twenty minutes and it is the reason clients refer you. Do it once. Doing it every time turns a business into a charity.

DAY 25 Onboard and collect inputs

OBJECTIVE The client knows exactly what happens next, and you have everything you need to start.

TASK Send the onboarding message and the scope document. Collect the inputs — photos, prices, access, whatever your offer requires. If inputs do not arrive within two days, send one short reminder with the date you need them by.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* A café owner sends 34 phone photos, most of them dark and one of a car park. The reader replies: "I can use eleven of these. Can you take six more near the window in the morning? Here are three examples of the angle." The client sends them the same evening.

OUTPUT Onboarding sent, scope sent, inputs received or a reminder sent with a deadline.

CHECK

- [ ] The client could describe the process back to me
- [ ] The scope document lists what is not included
- [ ] I have every input I need, or a dated reminder outstanding
- [ ] I did not start work before the deposit appeared

DAY 26 Produce the first half

OBJECTIVE Half the deliverable finished and sent early for a direction check.

TASK Produce the first half. Send it before it is perfect, with one question: "Is this the direction you want?" Correcting direction on day one is cheap. Correcting it on the last day is not.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Six of twelve posts are sent. The owner replies that the captions are too formal and the café's customers speak the local language. Two hours of rewriting, caught early instead of after all twelve were built.

OUTPUT Half the work delivered and one direction question asked.

CHECK

- [ ] Half the deliverable is finished, not a sketch of it
- [ ] I asked one specific direction question
- [ ] I sent it compressed and easy to open on a phone

DAY 27 Finish and revise

OBJECTIVE The complete deliverable, revised once, ready to hand over.

TASK Apply the direction feedback and finish everything. Do one revision round. Check every file opens, every spelling of the business name is right, every price is current, and no placeholder text survived.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* Before sending, the reader checks the café's name in all twelve captions, confirms the opening hours match the Google listing, and finds that one post still says "Insert price here". That single check is worth more than an extra hour of design.

OUTPUT A finished, checked deliverable in a named folder.

CHECK

- [ ] Every file opens
- [ ] Every business name is spelled correctly
- [ ] Every price and hour is current
- [ ] No placeholder text remains anywhere
- [ ] Total folder size is small enough to open on a phone

DAY 28 Deliver and collect the balance

OBJECTIVE Delivered, balance collected, and one over-delivery given.

TASK Send the delivery message with one instruction per file and one small bonus. Ask for the balance. Do not hand over final files until the balance is visible in your account.

EXAMPLE *Example scenario — fictional.* The bonus is a cleaned-up version of the café's logo as a PNG with a transparent background — twenty minutes of work that the owner had wanted for two years and never asked for.

OUTPUT Delivered, balance received, files handed over.

CHECK

- [ ] Every file has an instruction line
- [ ] I gave exactly one bonus, not three
- [ ] The balance is visible in my own account before final handover
- [ ] Score sheet updated with dollars collected

08

DAYS 29 TO 30

Payment, Testimonials and the Finish

Two days to collect money through a route that exists for a resident of a country with limited payment access, ask for a testimonial honestly, and close the challenge.

01 The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

02 Local clients versus international clients

03 The legitimate routes, in order

04 What never to do

05 Tax and registration, honestly

SECTION 08

08. Payment, Testimonials and the Finish

This section is the one most local online-income material handles badly. It is also the one that decides whether the thirty days produced money or a hobby.

Collecting the Money

This is the chapter that decides whether the rest of the book turns into money. It is also the chapter most online advice gets wrong, because most online advice assumes you live in a country with a full set of payment rails. If you do, the short version is at the end of this section. If you do not, the rest of this section is for you.

> **THE ONE RULE THAT PREVENTS ALMOST EVERY PROBLEM**
>
> **Agree the payment route with the client before you agree the price.** Not after the work is done, not in the invoice, not when they ask for your bank details. Before.
>
> A client who cannot pay you the way you need is not a client. They are a conversation. Finding that out on delivery day is the most expensive lesson in this book, and it is entirely avoidable with one question asked early.

How money actually crosses a border

When a client in another country pays you, the money does not travel directly. It moves through a chain, and every link in that chain is a place where it can stop. Knowing the chain tells you which question to ask.

1. **The client pays something**
   A card, a PayPal balance, a bank transfer, a mobile wallet, a local payment method. What they can use depends on *their* country, not yours.

2. **A processor authorises it**
   Stripe, PayPal, Adyen, a regional gateway. This is where most cross-border problems originate, because processors operate country by country.

3. **A platform holds it**
   If you sell through a marketplace or course platform, they hold the money and pay you later, on their schedule, at their minimum.

4. **It is paid out to you**
   A bank deposit in your local currency, a PayPal transfer, or a wallet credit. **This is the link that fails most often**, and it is the one nobody checks before they start.

EXPLAIN Buyer-side and seller-side are independent. What your client can use to pay has nothing to do with what you can receive. A platform can be perfectly good for your buyers and completely useless for paying you.

SHOW *Example — fictional.* A writer in Nairobi sells a $25 template pack. Buyers pay by card without difficulty. The platform's payout page then shows one option: PayPal. The writer's PayPal account can send but cannot receive. Fourteen sales, $350, stuck behind a payout route that was never tested.

DO Before you build anything, open the payout settings of every platform you are considering and write down, in one sentence, exactly how money would reach your bank account.

CHECK Can you name the rail, the currency, the minimum payout and the delay? If any of those four is a guess, you have not finished checking.

The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

Do this once per platform. It takes about twenty minutes and it prevents weeks of wasted work.

QUESTION	WHERE TO LOOK	WHAT A USABLE ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
1. Does this platform pay out to my country?	The platform's own payout-settings page or help article — never a blog post, never a YouTube video	Your country named on the platform's own list, with the payout currency
2. Through which rail?	The same page	A named method: local bank deposit, PayPal, Payoneer, wallet. "Contact support" is not an answer
3. What is the minimum and the delay?	The payout help article	A number and a schedule, so you can plan cash flow
4. What does it cost in total?	The pricing page *and* the fees help article — they often disagree	Platform fee plus processing fee, added together, expressed as a percentage of a typical sale

TWO RULES THAT WILL SAVE YOU MONEY

Read the payout page, not the signup page. Almost every platform lets you sign up from almost anywhere. That tells you nothing. The gate is payout.

Check whether two platforms share a rail. If two services both pay through the same underlying processor, they are not backups of each other. When that one rail has a problem, both stop at once. Verify the underlying rail, not just the brand on the front.

Local clients versus international clients

These are two different problems and they need two different answers. Do not let one delay the other.

	LOCAL CLIENTS	INTERNATIONAL CLIENTS
What works	Bank transfer, mobile wallet, cash, a local card gateway. Almost always available to an individual with no registered business.	A licensed remittance corridor, a platform that pays out to your country, or an employer's own payroll route.
Speed	Same day, often same hour	Days to weeks, depending on the platform's payout schedule
What can block it	Nothing much, if you have an account in your own name	Country eligibility, missing documents, a rail that does not reach you
Best first move	Start here. Local clients pay for your proof.	Test the payout route with a small real payment before you promise anything

THE TEST PAYMENT

Before you quote a single international client, run one small real transaction end to end: sell something cheap — a $5 template, a $10 review, a single small job — and take it all the way to money in your account.

This costs you one afternoon and one small fee. It converts every assumption in this chapter into a fact, and it is the single most useful hour in this entire book.

What to say to a client about payment

Clients are not suspicious of payment questions. They are suspicious of vague ones. Say the route plainly, in the first conversation, in writing.

COPY-READY: THE PAYMENT-ROUTING MESSAGE

Before we start, one practical thing so neither of us has a surprise at the end.

I am paid by **[route: bank transfer / a named platform / a licensed transfer service]**. The money arrives in **[currency]**, and I can start work as soon as the first payment shows on my side.

If you would rather use a different method, tell me now and I will check whether it works — I would rather spend five minutes on this today than a week on it later.

For **[amount]** the split is **[50]** % to start and **[50]** % on delivery.

COPY-READY: WHEN A PAYMENT IS LATE

Hello **[name]** — checking in on the **[amount]** for **[work]**, which I sent on **[date]**. It has not shown on my side yet.

Could you confirm the date it was sent and the reference number? If it has not gone out yet, no problem — just let me know when it will, and I will plan around that.

Pricing when the route costs money

Cross-border routes cost the sender or the receiver money. Decide who absorbs it before you quote, and put it in the price rather than discovering it later.

WORKED EXAMPLE — TARGET ARITHMETIC, NOT A FORECAST

```
Your price for the work: $100
Transfer or platform cost, if you absorb it: $5–$15
What actually reaches you: $85–$95
```

Two ways to handle it: quote a price that already includes the cost, or state plainly that transfer fees are the sender's. What you must not do is quote $100 and then argue about $12 after delivery.

NEVER DO THESE THINGS, WHATEVER ANYONE TELLS YOU

— **Never enter a false country, name or address** on a payment platform. It breaches the provider's terms, it usually fails identity verification anyway, and the consequence is a frozen balance and a closed account — with your customers refunded and your earnings gone.

— **Never use a relative's or friend's account abroad** to receive money that is yours. It is the same misrepresentation with extra steps, and it puts their account at risk too.

— **Never use a VPN to open a financial account** in a country you do not live in.

— **Never buy or rent a verified account.** The seller keeps access to it.

— **Never accept payment in a form your country restricts.** Several countries prohibit or restrict virtual-asset transactions; check your own before you accept anything unusual.

The published terms are unambiguous about this. Most platforms require you not to "create an account using a false identity or information, or on behalf of someone other than yourself", and prohibit misrepresenting your "identity, location or credentials". The stated remedy is suspension or termination, and where an underlying processor makes the final call it is often not appealable.

The legitimate routes, in the order worth trying

#	ROUTE	WHO IT SUITS	WHAT TO VERIFY FIRST
1	A platform that publishes your country on its own payout list, paying into a local bank account in local currency	Anyone selling digital products or courses	That the payout page offers *bank deposit*, not "PayPal only", for your country
2	A licensed money-transfer service (Western Union, MoneyGram, Remitly, WorldRemit and similar) for a one-off client payment	Freelancers and service sellers with a single client	That the receiving country and currency appear on the provider's own corridor list
3	An employer's own payroll or contractor route	Remote employees and long-term contractors	That the employer has paid a contractor in your country before — ask them directly
4	Registering as an exporter of services and receiving into a foreign-currency account	Anyone earning regularly from abroad	Your own country's rules. In several countries this unlocks full retention of foreign-currency earnings and an international card — ask a local accountant, do not guess
5	Trading through a properly registered company in the country where the payout account sits	Established sellers doing meaningful volume	Real incorporation, a real bank account there, real accounting, and any home-country approval required. Legitimate, but slow and expensive — not a shortcut

IF YOU ALREADY HAVE FULL PAYMENT RAILS

Then most of this chapter is not your constraint, and your fastest route is whatever your clients already use: Stripe, PayPal, a card gateway. Skim the four verification questions above anyway — the platform fee difference between two similar services is often several percentage points, and on a hundred sales a year that is real money.

Tax and registration, stated honestly

THIS IS NOT TAX ADVICE, AND THE RULES ARE LOCAL

Almost every country requires you to declare income you earn, and most require some form of tax registration once you are trading. What that means in practice — a tax number, a business registration, a turnover-tax threshold, a VAT threshold — differs enormously from country to country, and the thresholds change.

What to do: find your national tax authority's own website, look for the page on registering as a sole trader or self-employed person, and read the current threshold. If your earnings are small, you may be below every threshold. If they are not, register. A local accountant charges very little for one hour of advice, and that hour is worth more than any general guidance in a book written for the whole world.

Keep a simple record from your first sale: date, client, amount, currency, what it was for, and the fee deducted. That one sheet makes tax time trivial and makes you look professional if anyone ever asks.

IF YOU SELL THROUGH A MARKETPLACE, READ THIS

Large platforms are often the *merchant of record*, meaning they handle sales tax and VAT for the buyer and remit it themselves. That does not remove your obligation to declare the income you receive. It changes what you have to collect, not whether you have to report.

Some platforms also require a tax form before they will pay you at all — a W-9 if you are in the United States, a W-8 series form if you are not, or a local equivalent. If a form is required and not submitted, payouts are usually paused. Complete it early rather than after your first sale.

CLOSING

What Breaks the Challenge

Fourteen ways this thirty days fails. Each one is common, each one is fixable, and every fix is smaller than the mistake.

MISTAKE	WHAT HAPPENS	THE FIX
01. Choosing a market that is too big	"Small businesses where you live" produces messages that could be sent to anyone, and they read that way.	Name a place, a buyer type and a way in, on paper, before Day 4.
02. Changing the market in week two	You restart the clock with twelve days left, and finish with two half-built attempts.	The no-switching rule. Day 21 is the earliest.

MISTAKE	WHAT HAPPENS	THE FIX
03. Building instead of contacting	You spend nine days perfecting a logo and send four messages.	Days 16–21 are for conversations only. No building.

MISTAKE	WHAT HAPPENS	THE FIX
04. Writing one message for everybody	Reply rate collapses because the first line is not specific.	Personalise the first line from your observation column. Ninety seconds per message.

MISTAKE	WHAT HAPPENS	THE FIX
05. Sending two messages and stopping	No replies, and the conclusion that the market is dead.	Eight a day. Forty-eight across the outreach week.
06. Discounting at the first "too expensive"	The client learns your first number was not real. Every future price is negotiated down.	Reduce scope, never price. The Starter package exists for this.
07. Giving a price without a deliverable list	The scope grows quietly and a three-hour job becomes three weeks.	Send the scope document with the onboarding message.

MISTAKE	WHAT HAPPENS	THE FIX
08. Starting work before the deposit shows	You do the work and the money never arrives.	Confirm the balance in your own app, not in a screenshot.
09. Delivering without instructions	The client receives good work and never uses it, concludes it did not help, and does not renew.	One action line per file in the delivery message.
10. Writing the testimonial yourself	It reads like marketing and nobody believes it.	Ask, in their words, and publish it unedited.
11. Spending the first money on branding	The working capital that should have bought data and a tripod goes into a logo nobody asked for.	The reinvestment table in section 9.3.
12. Taking a second client with the same deadline	Both deliveries slip, and you lose the referral from both.	Stagger start dates by at least three days.
13. Not recording the zero days	The score sheet becomes flattering and stops being useful.	Fill in the row before you sleep, even when it says zero.
14. Treating one month as a verdict	You conclude something about yourself from thirty days of data.	Thirty days is one experiment. Month two is where the data becomes an advantage.

Frequently Asked Questions

What if I miss a day?

Do the day you missed the next morning, and keep the calendar order. Do not skip forward. The sequence matters more than the dates — Day 16 outreach without the Day 13 list produces messages to nobody in particular.

Can I change my market mid-challenge?

Once, on Day 21, and only after forty conversations. If you have not yet had forty conversations, the market is not the problem.

What if nobody replies in week two?

Week two is when conversations start, so a quiet week two is normal. Check three things in order: did you actually send forty-eight messages; is the first line specific to each business; and is the ask small enough to answer in one word. Fix the first thing that is wrong, not all three.

How much money do I need to start?

Zero, beyond the data bundle you already buy. Every tool in this challenge has a free path. Where a paid upgrade exists, it is optional and this book gives a free alternative.

Do I need a laptop?

No. The thirty days are designed to run on a phone. A laptop speeds up bulk photo editing and long documents. Where a task genuinely needs one, the daily card says so.

Do I need a business licence?

Not to start. An individual can receive payment from local clients by wallet transfer or bank transfer. A merchant gateway such as a local card-and-wallet gateway requires a registered business with a trade licence, TIN and Memorandum of Association. Register when a client needs an invoice with a company name, or when you want card payments — not before, unless you want to.

How do I get paid?

Local clients: wallet or bank transfer, confirmed in your own app. Foreign clients: through a provider on the your central bank or financial regulator's licensed remittance list, with the sender paying the transfer fee and the exchange spread. There is no verified direct PayPal, Payoneer, Wise or Stripe receiving rail for a resident of a country with limited payment access, so verify before you promise a client a method. Never fake your country, never rent an account, never use virtual assets.

What if I only have 1 GB of data left?

Switch to text for the rest of the day. Messages, follow-ups and tracker updates use almost nothing. Defer uploads and any photo editing to the morning, and compress before you send. A 720p video and a compressed JPEG will get through a connection that a raw phone photo will not.

What if I finish with nothing?

Read section 9.2 and identify which of the three failure points applies: too few conversations, the wrong message, or the wrong price conversation. Each has one fix. "your country does not work" is not one of the three, and the score sheet will show you why.

Can I do this alongside a job or studies?

Yes, and the plan assumes it. Ninety minutes a day is the design target. If your week is unusually heavy, use a buffer day and continue — do not compress two days into one.

Will this work outside your city?

Often better. There are usually fewer people offering digital services in a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city and smaller towns, and face-to-face selling is stronger there. What changes is the price ceiling — ask local businesses what they currently pay before you set your number.

What about tax?

A TIN is mandatory if you are earning. Turnover Tax under your country's turnover-tax rules is 2% on goods sold locally and 10% on other services, and does not apply where VAT applies. Presumptive or Category C rules could not be verified for this book — **confirm your position at your local tax office.** This book is not tax advice.

Is this a scam?

Test it. This book does not ask you for money, does not sell you a tool, does not promise an income figure, and does not contain a single testimonial or earnings screenshot. Everything it tells you to do is work you do for a person who pays you directly, with no intermediary taking a cut. If any part of it does not hold up when you try it, that is what the score sheet is for.

Can I sell this challenge to other people?

No. Redistributing this file is not permitted. If somebody you know would benefit, send them to the shop. Teaching the method to clients as part of paid work you deliver is a different thing and perfectly fine.

How to Spot a Fake Opportunity

Thirty days of outreach will put you in front of people who want to sell you something. Some of them are criminals. Here is how they look.

THE YOUR CENTRAL BANK OR FINANCIAL REGULATOR'S OWN WARNING

The your regulator's customer fraud awareness campaign states that fraudsters increasingly use **WhatsApp, Telegram, Facebook, email, SMS and unsolicited or fake phone calls** to impersonate individuals and request urgent financial transfers. It cites your regulator your financial-consumer-protection law and the your financial-consumer-protection rules.

Report suspicious activity to **your regulator's complaint address** or **6230**.

The patterns you will actually meet

THE PITCH	WHAT IT REALLY IS	THE TELL
"Pay a registration fee and we will give you the job."	Job scam. Real employers pay you; they never charge you to be hired.	Any payment requested before work exists.
"We are from Telegram security. Confirm your password and the code we sent."	Account takeover. This is a documented local scam: criminals pose as Telegram staff, harvest passwords and one-time codes, seize the account, then message your contacts asking for money.	**No legitimate platform ever asks for your password or your one-time code.**

THE PITCH	WHAT IT REALLY IS	THE TELL
"Rent out your bank account or wallet for a monthly fee."	Money laundering. Your account becomes the trail for somebody else's crime, and you are the named account holder.	Anyone offering to pay for access to your account.

THE PITCH	WHAT IT REALLY IS	THE TELL
"Send your ID photo to complete registration."	Identity harvesting. Legitimate employers need your ID only after a written offer, and only through an official channel.	An ID request in a chat, before an interview.
"Invest $120 and receive 15,000 in three weeks."	A Ponzi or pyramid scheme. The returns are paid from the next person's deposit.	Any fixed high return. Anyone guaranteeing a profit.

THE PITCH	WHAT IT REALLY IS	THE TELL
"Trade crypto with our bot — guaranteed daily profit."	Investment fraud, and virtual-asset activity is prohibited where you live unless expressly authorised.	The words "guaranteed" and "daily profit" in the same sentence.
"We will sponsor your visa for a fee."	Migration fraud. The fee is the product.	Money requested for a document you have not seen.
"Here is the transfer screenshot — please deliver now."	Fake payment confirmation. Screenshots can be edited and pending transfers can fail.	Any payment that is not visible in your own app.
"Buy this course and earn $50,000 a month."	Income fantasy. The seller's income comes from selling the course, not from the method it teaches.	Any specific income promise attached to a purchase.

The eight-point legitimacy check

Run every opportunity through this before you spend money, share a document, or do unpaid work.

- [ ] Nobody asked me for money to be considered.
- [ ] Nobody asked for my password, PIN or a one-time code.
- [ ] Nobody asked for access to my bank or wallet account.
- [ ] The person or company has a traceable identity I can verify independently — not only what they told me.
- [ ] The offer is specific about what I do, what I receive, and when.
- [ ] There is no guaranteed income, guaranteed return, or fixed profit figure.
- [ ] There is no urgency to decide today, and no countdown.
- [ ] Payment happens through a licensed route, in my own name, confirmed in my own account.

ONE RULE COVERS MOST OF IT

If you have to pay to start earning, or hand over access to an account in your name, it is not an opportunity. Everything legitimate in this book works the other way round: a real client sends money to you, and you never give anyone your codes.

Sources & Further Reading

Every platform figure in this book traces to one of the sources below, all checked in September 2026. Platform country lists, payout methods and fees change often — confirm anything you intend to rely on at the source itself.

1. Gumroad — pricing and fee structure — https://gumroad.com/pricing
2. Gumroad — getting paid, bank-payout country list and payout schedule — https://gumroad.com/help/article/13-getting-paid
3. Gumroad — fees in detail — https://gumroad.com/help/article/66-gumroads-fees
4. Gumroad — payout settings, identity documents and tax IDs — https://gumroad.com/help/article/260-your-payout-settings-page
5. Gumroad — account suspension and what causes it — https://gumroad.com/help/article/160-suspension
6. Gumroad — terms of service (identity, location and account rules) — https://gumroad.com/terms
7. Lemon Squeezy — supported countries for sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/getting-started/supported-countries
8. Lemon Squeezy — W-8 and W-9 tax forms for non-US sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/tax-forms/w8-w9-forms
9. Lemon Squeezy — pricing — https://www.lemonsqueezy.com/pricing
10. Stripe — cross-border payouts and supported regions — https://docs.stripe.com/connect/cross-border-payouts
11. IRS — About Form W-8BEN — https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-w-8-ben
12. IRS — United States income tax treaties A to Z — https://www.irs.gov/businesses/international-businesses/united-states-income-tax-treaties-a-to-z
13. Whop — payout methods and countries — https://docs.whop.com/manage-your-business/manage-payouts/payout-methods
14. Payhip — how sellers get paid — https://help.payhip.com/article/173-how-do-i-get-paid
15. Ko-fi — how creators get paid — https://help.ko-fi.com/hc/en-us/articles/115003980093-How-do-I-get-paid
16. Fungies — countries you can sell from — https://fungies.io/global-availability/
17. Telegram — Telegram Stars for digital goods — https://telegram.org/blog/telegram-stars
18. Google — Business Profile supported countries — https://support.google.com/business/answer/6270107
19. YouTube — Partner Program availability by country — https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/7101720
20. DataReportal — global digital statistics — https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-global-overview-report
21. World Bank — World Development Indicators — https://databank.worldbank.org/source/world-development-indicators
22. International Labour Organization — ILOSTAT employment data — https://ilostat.ilo.org/
23. Internet Society — Internet shutdown and disruption reporting — https://www.internetsociety.org/
24. FATF — virtual asset and payment-service guidance by jurisdiction — https://www.fatf-gafi.org/

Where research could not verify a fact, this book says so in the text and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

Final Checklist

Twenty-eight things that should be true by Day 30. Tick them honestly. An unticked box is not a failure — it is next month's to-do list.

The market

- [ ] I named a market with a place, a buyer type, a problem and a way in
- [ ] I scored three candidates and chose one
- [ ] I wrote the market line down and kept it visible
- [ ] I did not change my market before Day 21
- [ ] I can name at least fifteen businesses in my market

The offer

- [ ] My offer is under 90 words and contains all five parts
- [ ] My price traces back to my real delivery time
- [ ] I have three tiers and the one I want to sell is in the middle
- [ ] I can say every price out loud without hesitating
- [ ] I have a written scope that names what is not included

The proof

- [ ] I have three samples and every one is clearly labelled as sample work
- [ ] I did not present anybody else's work as mine
- [ ] I asked permission before publishing a redesign of a real business
- [ ] My samples live in one folder under 20 MB with view access on
- [ ] I tested the folder link on somebody else's phone

The outreach

- [ ] My tracker has forty qualified rows
- [ ] Every row has a written observation in my own words
- [ ] Every contacted row has a next action date
- [ ] I started at least forty conversations
- [ ] I personalised the first line of every message
- [ ] I completed every follow-up without skipping to a new prospect instead
- [ ] I recorded every refusal in the client's own words

The money

- [ ] I asked for a deposit before starting work
- [ ] I confirmed every payment in my own wallet or bank app
- [ ] I reduced scope rather than discounting a price
- [ ] I requested a testimonial and did not write it myself
- [ ] I offered at least one client a monthly arrangement

The record

- [ ] My score sheet has thirty completed rows, including the zeros
- [ ] I have written down which channel produced the most replies
- [ ] I have written down what I will do more of in month two

THE FINAL CHALLENGE

Final Challenge: Complete the 30-Day 10,000-Dollars Challenge

Thirty daily cards. Forty prospects. Forty-eight conversations. One delivered piece of work. One score sheet with thirty rows, including every day that says zero.

01 Choose one market and write it down. Do not change it before Day 21.

02 Build one offer with a price in dollars, a countable deliverable and a delivery time.

03 Build three samples, every one labelled as sample work.

04 Build a list of forty named businesses with a phone number and an observation each.

05 Start eight conversations a day for six days. Do not stop at two.

06 Send every proposal with three prices and a dated next step.

07 Deliver the work, collect the balance in your own account, and ask for one testimonial and one referral.

08 Fill in all thirty rows and write down what you will double in month two.

The $500 figure is a target used to size the work, not a promise about your result. What completing it does give you is a written record of your own conversion rates, one honest piece of proof, and a working offer — three things almost nobody who tries to earn online where you live ever has.

NEXT STEPS

Where To Go From Here

The challenge gives you a working offer. The next course depends on which part of it you want to grow.

IF YOUR THIRTY DAYS SHOWED…	CONTINUE WITH	BECAUSE
That you can sell work but need more clients from abroad	**Course 02 — The local Freelancer Starter System**	Deeper proposal writing, platform mechanics and objection handling
That local businesses buy social media from you	**Course 04 — The Social Media Manager Starter Course**	Audits, content calendars, monthly packages and retention
That design work sold fastest	**Course 05 — Canva to Cash**	Ten service packages, print realities and revision handling
That you would rather sell files than hours	**Course 06 — Sell Digital Products From your country**	Validation, pricing, delivery, licensing and refunds
That you want a salary rather than clients	**Course 07 — The Remote Work Starter System**	CV, proof, interviews, time zones and getting paid by an employer
That your content brought the buyers in	**Course 08 — TikTok, Instagram & Telegram Income System**	Niche, pillars, hooks and six honest monetization paths
That you want to add services and raise monthly value	**Course 09 — The local Online Service Business**	Ten services with offers, scripts and recurring revenue paths
That you want to move faster with fewer hours	**Course 03 — AI Income for locals**	Twelve AI-assisted services and the quality control that keeps clients

THE SINGLE THING TO CARRY FORWARD

Whatever your thirty days produced, the number that predicted it was **conversations started**. That number is entirely within your control, it costs nothing, and it is the only input in this entire system that you can decide to double tomorrow.

Double it.

NexKit your country Editorial Team · First Edition · September 2026 · This course is educational material only. It does not guarantee income. Examples are illustrative and all businesses named in it are fictional. Readers are responsible for complying with local law, tax obligations, platform rules and payment-provider requirements. Nothing here is financial, legal or investment advice.

GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

The 30-Day Digital Business Challenge

Build Your First Small Online Income System in 30 Days

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Read This Before Day One

The $500 Digital Business Challenge — Build Your First Small Online Income System in 30 Days. First Edition · September 2026.

Publisher: NexKit your country Editorial Team. This course was researched, written and edited by the NexKit your country Editorial Team. It carries no individual author name and no personal credentials, because the value of the book is the method, not a personality.

Edition: First Edition · September 2026. Copyright in this edition rests with NexKit your country. Please do not redistribute the file. If a friend needs it, send them to the shop, not the PDF.

What this course is

A thirty-day implementation programme. Every day has an objective, an explanation, a task, an example, a checklist and an expected output. It takes you from choosing a market to delivering paid work, and it is designed to be run once, properly, rather than read twice.

What this course is not

It is not a promise that you will earn $500 in thirty days. **$500 is a target used to make the arithmetic concrete**, and it is one of several possible outcomes. Many people who complete this programme will earn less in the first month, some will earn nothing, and some will sign their first client in week five rather than week three. It is not financial, legal or tax advice, and it does not guarantee a client, a sale, a sponsorship or a payout.

DISCLAIMER — READ THIS ONCE, PROPERLY

This course is **educational material only**. Nothing in it is a guarantee of income, and nothing in it is financial, legal or investment advice.

The $500 target is arithmetic, not a forecast. Four worked paths are shown: five clients at $12, ten at $6, twenty at $3, and two at $120. Each is a **target calculation**. Which one is realistic for you depends on your market, your offer, your price and how many conversations you actually start.

All prices, rates and ladders shown in this book are **illustrative examples** for teaching. You are responsible for complying with local law, your tax obligations, the terms of service of any platform you use, and the requirements of any bank, wallet or payment provider you deal with. Rules, fees, limits and country availability change, sometimes quickly.

Where the underlying research could not verify a fact, this book says so and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

DATES, CURRENCY AND EXAMPLES

All money in this course is US US dollars (USD), written as $25. Where a United States dollar figure appears it states its rate and its date on the same line.

Every business named anywhere in these pages is invented. Each is labelled **Example scenario — fictional**. No real, recognisable local company is presented as a client, a case study or a testimonial.

Every figure cited is current as of **September 2026** unless a different date is printed beside it. Source URLs for those figures appear in the **Sources & Further Reading** section at the back of the book.

BEFORE YOU RELY ON ANY OF THIS

Payment limits, wallet rules, tax thresholds and platform availability are the parts of this book most likely to go stale. Treat every number as a starting point for your own check, not as a substitute for it. Where this book names a rule, confirm the current version with the institution that made it.

Last updated: September 2026. Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

What is inside this course

01 · Choose Your Market 10
02 · Choose Your Problem and Your Service 16
03 · Build the Offer and the Proof 22
04 · Build the Prospect List 29
05 · Outreach 34
06 · Proposals, Negotiation and Closing 41
07 · Delivery 46
08 · Payment, Testimonials and the Finish 51

HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.